

Trip plan — Dolomites Core (31 Aug - 6 Sep 2026)

7-day camping road trip from **Bergamo Airport (BGY)**. Focus: **beginner via ferrata** (grade A, fully protected), no hard unprotected scrambling.

Travellers assumed: 5 people, tent(s) + rental car. Adjust pitch count if using multiple tents.

Driving rule: **≤150 km per day** on move and activity days. **Day 2** is the main transfer (~**125 km** Iseo → Colfosco). Western base **Camping Colfosco** is ~**8 km** from Passo Gardena (Gran Cir). Day 1 is a short hop to **Lake Iseo** (~26 km from BGY). Return to BGY may exceed 150 km on Day 7 unless staged (see Day 7).

Budget: see [BUDGET.md](#) — total ~**€950-1,450** excluding flights (7 days, 5 people). Car hire from ~**€200** via Italian brands at BGY.

Equipment: see [EQUIPMENT.md](#).

All links: see [SOURCES.md](#).

Activity rules: [PRINCIPLES.md](#)

Calendar

Day	Date	Overnight	Main activity	Drive (km)
1	Sat 31 Aug	Camping del Sole, Lake Iseo	Arrive BGY → arrival camp	~26
2	Sun 1 Sep	Camping Colfosco, Corvara	Transfer → acclimatise	~125
3	Mon 2 Sep	Colfosco	Via Ferrata Gran Cir	~16 RT
4	Tue 3 Sep	Colfosco	Seceda ridge (cable car)	~30 RT
5	Wed 4 Sep	Camping Olympia, Dobbiaco	Transfer → Via Ferrata Ra Gusela	~63 + ~50 RT
6	Thu 5 Sep	Olympia	Tre Cime di Lavaredo loop	~35 RT
7	Fri 6 Sep	—	Drive to BGY (direct or staged)	~290 or ~140

Camping nights: 6 (1 Iseo + 3 Colfosco + 2 Olympia).

Why these dates work

- **31 Aug:** Last day of August — Ferragosto crowds mostly gone; infrastructure still fully open.
- **1-6 Sep:** Early September — often **clearer weather**, fewer afternoon storms than peak August ([Dolomites Journey](https://www.dolomitesjourney.com/dolomites-travel-tips/best-time-to-visit-dolomites) (<https://www.dolomitesjourney.com/dolomites-travel-tips/best-time-to-visit-dolomites>), [September guide](https://www.moonhoneytravel.com/hiking-dolomites-september/) (<https://www.moonhoneytravel.com/hiking-dolomites-september/>)).
- All rifugi, passes, and cable cars open through your dates.
- **Braies** (optional from Dobbiaco by bus 442) if Tre Cime weather fails on **5 Sep** — car access 09:00–16:00 restricted 1 Jul–15 Sep ([pragis.bz](https://www.pragis.bz) (<https://www.pragis.bz/en>)).

Weather checks (evening before each hike):

- Val Badia / Gardena: [Meteo Alto Adige](https://weather.provinz.bz.it/) (<https://weather.provinz.bz.it/>)
- Cortina / Tre Cime: [Dolomiti Meteo ARPAV](https://www.dolomiti-meteo.com/) (<https://www.dolomiti-meteo.com/>)
- Guide: [Hikes in the Dolomites — weather](https://www.hikesinthedolomites.com/weather/) (<https://www.hikesinthedolomites.com/weather/>)

Ferrata rule: If thunderstorms forecast after 12:00, skip exposed routes.

Driving & campsite strategy

150 km/day rule

Leg	km	Notes
BGY → Lake Iseo (Camping del Sole)	~26	Day 1 — gentle arrival (26 km from BGY (https://camplinq.com/camps/camping-del-sole-village/))
Iseo → Colfosco (Corvara)	~125	Day 2 — A4 → A22 → Bressanone/Val Pusteria → SS244; one long transfer
Colfosco → Passo Gardena (Gran Cir)	~8 one way	~ 16 km RT — closest full camp to ferrata
Colfosco → Ortisei (Seceda lift)	~15 one way	~ 30 km RT
Colfosco → Dobbiaco (Olympia)	~63	Day 5 move (Corvara-Dobbiaco ~63 km (https://www.percorsokm.it/it-it/percorso-da-Dobbiaco-a-Corvara_in_Badia))
Olympia → Passo Giau / Tre Cime	15-20 one way	Activity days
Dobbiaco → BGY (direct)	~290	Day 7 — over daily cap
Dobbiaco → Sarche / Iseo (exit staging)	~140 / ~99+	Optional split return

Why Iseo + Colfosco: Short day 1 after flying; **Camping Colfosco** saves ~**15 km/day** vs San Vigilio (Al Plan) for Gran Cir and Seceda. Cinque Torri dropped from departure day to allow an earlier start on the drive home.

Campsites — trailhead proximity

Wild camping is **illegal** in Dolomites nature parks.

Base	Nights	Campsite	Closest hikes	Drive to trailhead
Staging	31 Aug	Camping del Sole , Lake Iseo	Arrival camp	—
Alta Badia	1-3 Sep	Camping Colfosco , Corvara/Colfosco	Gran Cir, Seceda	8-15 km
Alta Pusteria	4-5 Sep	Camping Olympia , Dobbiaco	Ra Gusela, Tre Cime, Braies bus	15-25 km

Camp	Book
Iseo	campingdelsole.it (https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/)
Colfosco	campingcolfosco.org (https://www.campingcolfosco.org/)
Olympia	camping-olympia.com (https://www.camping-olympia.com/en/lago-di-braies-camping/)

Campsite map: [45 sites — interactive map](https://mountainsforeverybody.com/campsites-in-the-dolomites-interactive-map/) (<https://mountainsforeverybody.com/campsites-in-the-dolomites-interactive-map/>)

Olympia advantage: ~15 min to Braies shuttle (bus 442), Tre Cime shuttle (Line 444 from Dobbiaco), and Passo Giau — one base for the whole eastern block without daily camp moves.

5 people: book a **large pitch** or **two adjacent pitches**; confirm extra-adult fees when booking Colfosco and Olympia.

Scenic approach? [Garda-Iseo Corridor](#) covers Riva, Arco, and Valle dei Laghi over 5 days — then join Dolomites via Bressanone ([README](#)).

Strict ≤ 100 km/day for the full trip? Not compatible with 7 days from BGY — use [Garda-Iseo Corridor](#) as a scenic approach with extra nights, or fly closer (Verona / Bolzano).

Logistics overview

Car hire — yes, recommended

Pick up / drop off	BGY airport (recommended) or Bergamo city — see BUDGET.md § Car hire
Type	Estate / compact SUV / MPV — 5 people + tent kit
Cost	€200-490 for 7 days — Italian brands (Locauto, Sicily by Car) often €50-150 below Sixt/Hertz
Compare	DiscoverCars (https://www.discovercars.com/) · Rent.it BGY (https://www.rent.it/autonoleggio/italia-1/bergamo-34/bergamo_aeroporto_orio_al_serio_bgy-42/) · Sicily by Car (https://www.sicilybycar.it/it/noleggio-auto/italia/aeroporto-bergamo)
Why	Camping gear, ferrata trailheads, Tre Cime parking needs license plate

Local sellers: Autodiretto, FB65, BJ Auto in Bergamo city can undercut airport majors — but you need a **bus/taxi from BGY** (~€3-35) and must match **Saturday opening hours** (31 Aug). Only choose city pickup if the quote saves **>€50** vs an Italian brand at the airport desk.

All links: [SOURCES.md — Car hire](#)

Total driving (estimate)

~**750-900 km** for the week (well below the $150 \text{ km} \times 7 = 1,050 \text{ km}$ ceiling if you split the return).

Day 1 — Sat 31 Aug: Arrival at Lake Iseo

Mountain

Time	Activity
Morning / midday	Land BGY, collect rental car
Afternoon	Drive to Lake Iseo (~ 26 km , ~35 min via A4 Rovato exit), check in Camping del Sole

No mountain route today — travel day only.

Recovery

Time	Activity
Late afternoon	Optional swim at del Sole lakeside beach (~30 min)

Logistics

Time	Activity
Evening	Provision run — supermarket in Iseo (~20 min) for days 1-2

Costs today

Item	€
Car hire (daily share)	~€36-70
Motorway tolls (partial)	~€3-5
Fuel (partial)	~€5-10
Campsite night 1	~€50-80 (5 people)

Watch

- Easy first day — valley altitude ~200 m. No mountain hiking.
 - Supermarket in Iseo is a 10 min walk from camp (for provisioning only).
-

Day 2 — Sun 1 Sep: Into Alta Badia (Colfosco)

Mountain

Time	Activity
Afternoon	Easy valley walk from camp — acclimatise to ~ 1,500 m

Logistics

Time	Activity
07:30	Leave Iseo
10:30–11:00	Arrive Camping Colfosco (~ 125 km , A4 → A22 → Bressanone → SS49/SS244 to Corvara)
Midday	Pitch tent, provision run in Corvara (~20 min)

Costs today

Item	€
Motorway tolls	~€18–25
Fuel (partial)	~€20–30
Campsite night 2	~€45–70 pitch + electricity

Watch

- **Longest drive day** of the trip — start early, fuel on A22.
 - No via ferrata today.
 - Buy food in Corvara before Sunday evening closures.
-

Day 3 — Mon 2 Sep: Via Ferrata Gran Cir

Main ferrata day. Grade **A** — easiest classic in the Dolomites; mostly a protected hike.

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:00	Leave camp (~8 km to Passo Gardena)
07:45	Arrive Passo Gardena (2,121 m)
08:00–11:30	Gran Cir (+ optional Pitla Cir)
Afternoon	Rest at camp — save Braies for tomorrow

Route

Start	Passo Gardena — park at pass or Dantercepies lift area
Duration	1–1.5 h up Gran Cir; +1 h for Pitla Cir
Grade	A (beginner)
Gear	Helmet, harness, via ferrata lanyard — rent locally

Gear rental (pick up morning of 2 Sep)

Shop	Price	Link
Alta Badia Sport, La Villa	€20/day (set)	altabadiasport.it (https://altabadiasport.it/en/bike-rental-alta-badia/via-ferrata-set)
INTERSPORT Val Gardena, Selva	€27/day	valgardenasport.com (https://www.valgardenasport.com/en/via-ferrata-set/)
Lagazoi rental	€25/day	rent.lagazoi.it (https://rent.lagazoi.it/en/equipment-rental/9-via-ferrata-kit)

Rent **2 days** (2–3 Sep) → **€40** total per set at Alta Badia Sport.

Or bring own kit bought in Poland — [EQUIPMENT.md Appendix A](#).

Optional guide (first-timers): ~€250–350/group — [Guide Dolomiti](https://www.guidedolomiti.com/en/guided-via-ferrata-dolomites-with-a-local-expert/) (<https://www.guidedolomiti.com/en/guided-via-ferrata-dolomites-with-a-local-expert/>)

Costs today

Item	€
Ferrata kit rental (day 1 of 2)	20–27 per set
Campsite night 3	45–70
Rifugio lunch (optional)	15–25/person

Sources — read & watch before

Type	Link
YouTube	Piccolo + Grande Cir ferrata (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TD8s1AjNJRI)
Official route	Val Gardena — Gran Cir (https://www.valgardena.it/en/outdoor/base/outdoor/gran-cir-gran-cir-peak/810054754/)
Blog guide	In A Faraway Land — Gran Cir (https://inafarawayland.com/via-ferrata-gran-cir/)
Beginner list	13 beginner ferratas (https://inafarawayland.com/beginner-via-ferratas-italian-dolomites/)

Route map (marked ferrata): [Val Gardena — interactive map](https://www.valgardena.it/en/outdoor/base/outdoor/gran-cir-gran-cir-peak/810054754/) (https://www.valgardena.it/en/outdoor/base/outdoor/gran-cir-gran-cir-peak/810054754/)



Day 4 — Tue 3 Sep: Seceda ridge

Rest day from ferrata — iconic hike, ~30 km driving RT from Colfosco.

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:30	Drive to Ortisei (~15 km)
08:00	Seceda cable car up
08:30-13:00	Ridge walk toward Pierlongia / Regensburger Hütte viewpoint
Afternoon	Return to camp

Item	Cost
Seceda cable car return	~€25-35/person
Drive	~ 30 km RT

YouTube: [Seceda hike vlog](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_Y8FI4Esd0) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_Y8FI4Esd0)

Route map (marked trail): [Val Gardena Outdoor — Seceda ridge line](https://outdoor.valgardena.it/en/route/hiking-trail/seceda-ridge-line-from-ortisei/810055445/) (https://outdoor.valgardena.it/en/route/hiking-trail/seceda-ridge-line-from-ortisei/810055445/)




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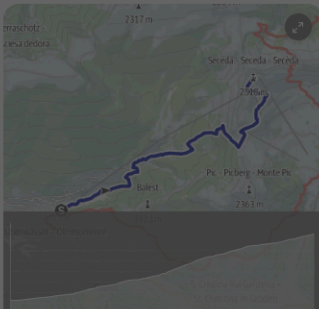
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Seceda – Ridge Line from Ortisei

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Weather backup

Easy **Puez-Odle** viewpoint trail from Passo Gardena (~**16 km** RT) if Seceda is in cloud — no lift cost.

Costs today

Item	€
Campsite night 4 (last at Colfosco)	45-70
Seceda lift	25-35/person

Day 5 — Wed 4 Sep: Move camp + Ra Gusela

Schedule

Time	Activity
08:00	Pack camp, drive to Dobbiaco (~63 km, ~1 h 15 min)
10:30	Check in Camping Olympia
12:00	Late lunch, rest
14:00	Drive to Passo Giau (~25 km)
14:30–17:30	Via Ferrata Ra Gusela loop to Rifugio Nuvolau

Route — Ra Gusela

Grade	A (beginner, family-friendly)
Duration	~3 h loop
Start	Passo Giau (2,236 m) — path 443 → 438
Gear	Same kit as day 3 — day 2 of 2-day rental

Costs today

Item	€
Ferrata kit (day 2 of rental)	included in €40/set
Campsite night 5	~€36–50
Braies (optional later from Dobbiaco by bus 442)	~5–15/person

Sources

Type	Link
Video	Ra Gusela loop from Passo Giau (https://www.monti.uno/video_montagna/Interessante/ferrata_e_cima_ra_gusela_anello_dal_passo_giau/9/52486)
Official	Cortina — Ra Gusela (https://cortina.dolomiti.org/en/vie-ferrate/via-ferrata-ra-gusela-en/)

Route map (marked ferrata): [Outdooractive — interactive map](https://www.outdooractive.com/en/routes/via-ferrata/ampezzaner-dolomiten/30.-via-ferrata-ra-gusela-nuvolau-2574-m-/58456823/) (https://www.outdooractive.com/en/routes/via-ferrata/ampezzaner-dolomiten/30.-via-ferrata-ra-gusela-nuvolau-2574-m-/58456823/)

outdooractive

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Routes → Italy → Ampezzo Dolomites → 30. Via Ferrata Ra Gusela (Nuvolau, 2574 m)

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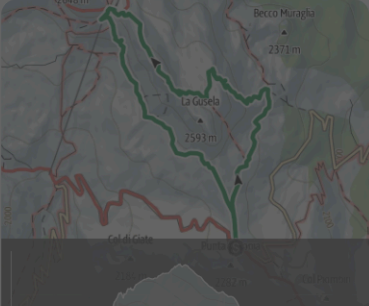
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30. Via Ferrata Ra Gusela (Nuvolau, 2574 m)

☆ No ratings (yet)



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Day 6 — Thu 5 Sep: Tre Cime di Lavaredo

Classic **hike** (~10 km loop, 3-4 h) — no ferrata kit needed. High altitude (~2,300 m) but well-marked path.

Schedule

Time	Activity
06:30	Leave camp (~ 18 km to toll road)
07:00	Arrive Rifugio Auronzo (booked slot)
07:15-12:00	Tre Cime loop (path 101 → Locatelli → Langalm → Auronzo)
Afternoon	Rest at camp

Access — book in advance

Option A — Car (recommended with gear in vehicle)

Item	Cost	Book
Parking + toll road, 12 hours	€40	pass.auronzo.info (https://pass.auronzo.info/)
Book entry slot	07:00	Opens ~1 month ahead — 5 Sep 2026

Option B — Shuttle from Dobbiaco (Line 444)

Item	Cost	Book
Return ticket, adult	€22	drei-zinnen.bz/ticket (https://www.drei-zinnen.bz/en/ticket)

Shuttle runs **31 May - 11 Oct 2026**.

Prices: [drei-zinnen.bz FAQ](https://www.drei-zinnen.bz/en/ticket) (<https://www.drei-zinnen.bz/en/ticket>) • [auronzo.info parking 2026](https://auronzo.info/en/parking-tre-cime-di-lavaredo/) (<https://auronzo.info/en/parking-tre-cime-di-lavaredo/>)

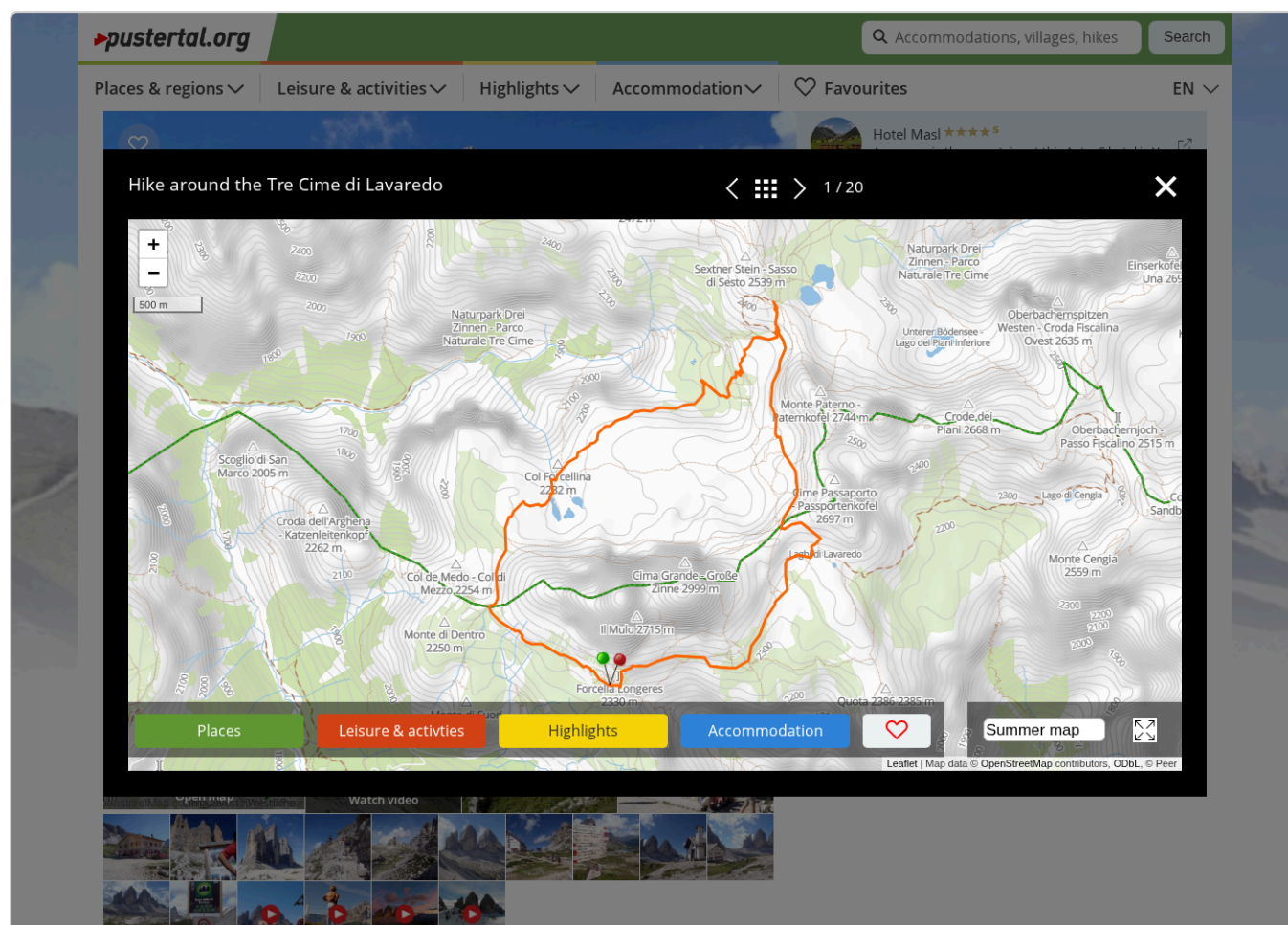
Costs today

Item	€
Tre Cime parking OR shuttle	40 or 22/person
Campsite night 6	36-50
Rifugio lunch on trail	15-25/person

Sources

Type	Link
YouTube	Tre Cime loop hike (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1jmTOj_U3qQ)
2026 guide + map	Throne & Vine — Tre Cime (https://throneandvine.com/tre-cime-di-lavaredo-drei-zinnen-guide/)
Official visitor info	auronzo.info (https://auronzo.info/en/tre-cime-di-lavaredo-dolomites/)

Route map (marked trail): [Pustertal — Tre Cime circular hike map](https://www.pustertal.org/en/leisure-activities/mountains-and-hiking/hiking-in-alta-pusteria-three-peaks/tre-cime-di-lavaredo-circular-hike/) (https://www.pustertal.org/en/leisure-activities/mountains-and-hiking/hiking-in-alta-pusteria-three-peaks/tre-cime-di-lavaredo-circular-hike/) (click **Open map** on the page)



Weather backup

Lago di Braies by bus 442 from Dobbiaco (~€5-15) if Tre Cime is in cloud.

Day 7 — Fri 6 Sep: Departure

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:00	Pack camp, check out Olympia
07:30	Start drive toward BGY
~11:00–12:00	Arrive BGY area (direct ~ 290 km , ~3 h 30 min)
Afternoon	Return car, fly home

Cinque Torri removed from this day — saves ~25 km and 3 h so you can leave earlier for the long drive.

Return drive — options

Option	Route	km	Best for
A — Direct	Dobbiaco → A22 → A4 → BGY	~ 290	Afternoon/evening flight; one long day
B — Staged via Sarche	Day 7: Dobbiaco → Sarche (~140 km), night camp; Day 8: Sarche → BGY (~145 km)	≤ 150/day	Morning flight 7 Sep — needs extra holiday day
C — Staged via Iseo	Day 7: Dobbiaco → Iseo area (~280 km split impossible in one day under 150)	—	Use Sarche or fly from Verona instead

Costs today

Item	€
Fuel + tolls (return leg)	~€55–75
Car hire (final day)	included in total

Allow 3.5+ hours Dobbiaco → BGY on Option A, plus fuel stop and car return.

Via ferrata summary

Routes chosen for **full cable protection** — no long exposed scrambling without gear.

Route	Date	Grade	Time	Drive from camp
Gran Cir	2 Sep	A	1-1.5 h	8 km
Pitla Cir (optional)	2 Sep	A	+1 h	same
Ra Gusela	4 Sep	A	~3 h	25 km

Not planned (too advanced for this trip): Sassolungo, Tofana di Mezzo, VF Tridentina.

Learn before you go:

Resource	Link
Ultimate beginner guide	Brooke Beyond (https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites)
10 best routes	Brooke Beyond — top 10 (https://brookebeyond.com/10-best-via-ferrata-routes-in-the-italian-dolomites)
Official by level	dolomites.com (https://www.dolomites.com/travel-guide/sports-activities/via-ferrata)

Hiking summary (non-ferrata)

Route	Date	Time	Drive from camp
Seceda ridge	3 Sep	4-5 h	15 km
Tre Cime loop	5 Sep	3-4 h	18 km

Optional (not in 7-day plan): Lago di Braies (bus from Dobbiaco); Cinque Torri (near Passo Giau) if you add a day or skip Seceda.

Packing & equipment

Full checklist (ferrata, hiking, camping, documents): [EQUIPMENT.md](#)

Booking checklist

☐	Item	When	Link	Cost
☐	Car hire (7 days, estate/SUV)	ASAP	DiscoverCars (https://www.discovercars.com/) · Rent.it (https://www.rent.it/autonoleggio/italia-1/bergamo-34/bergamo_aeroporto_orio_al_serio_bgy-42/) · compare Locauto (https://www.locauto.it/) / Sicily by Car (https://www.sicilybycar.it/it/noleggio-auto/italia/aeroporto-bergamo)	€200–490
☐	Camping del Sole, Iseo (31 Aug)	ASAP	campingdelsole.it (https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/)	~€50–80
☐	Camping Colfosco (1–3 Sep)	ASAP	campingcolfosco.org (https://www.campingcolfosco.org/)	~€135–210
☐	Camping Olympia (4–5 Sep)	ASAP	camping-olympia.com (https://www.camping-olympia.com/en/lago-di-braies-camping/)	~€72–100
☐	Tre Cime parking 5 Sep, 07:00	~Aug 5	pass.auronzo.info (https://pass.auronzo.info/)	€40
☐	OR Tre Cime shuttle return	~Aug 5	drei-zinnen.bz/ticket (https://www.drei-zinnen.bz/en/ticket)	€22/person
☐	Ferrata kit × 5 sets	Before trip or rent 2 Sep	Appendix A — buy in PL · Alta Badia Sport (https://altabadiasport.it/en/bike-rental-alta-badia/via-ferrata-set)	€0 (owned) or €40/2 days per set
☐	Sarche (optional exit night)	If staged return	camping-sarche.it (https://www.camping-sarche.it/)	~€54–75

Suggested pre-trip viewing (order)

1. [5-Day Dolomites Itinerary — YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=seoabp3ooSg) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=seoabp3ooSg)
2. [Gran Cir ferrata — YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TD8s1AjNJRI) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TD8s1AjNJRI)
3. [Seceda hike — YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_Y8FI4Esd0) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_Y8FI4Esd0)
4. [Ra Gusela — video](https://www.monti.uno/video_montagna/Interessante/ferrata_e_cima_ra_gusela_anello_dal_passo_giau/9/52486) (https://www.monti.uno/video_montagna/Interessante/ferrata_e_cima_ra_gusela_anello_dal_passo_giau/9/52486)
5. [Tre Cime loop — YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1jmTOj_U3qQ) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1jmTOj_U3qQ)
6. Read [Brooke Beyond beginner guide](https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites) (https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites)

Full link list: [SOURCES.md](#).